

Frank Lloyd Wrong

Your grievance with Grant

Grant demanded a dangerous last-minute change to the centerpiece display and threatened to withhold your firm's final payment if you refused. He also planned to blame you publicly for any flaw in the opening-night presentation.

Your other secret

You signed off on one temporary lighting rig that did not fully meet your own design standard because there was no time to rebuild it before the gala.

Three things to try before dinner

1. Introduce yourself to someone you do not already know. Your role and pre-party sheet are enough.
2. Keep Chip from turning the temporary rig into a formal safety dispute.
3. Find out what Minnie changed after your final walkthrough.

When a named contact is absent, discuss that issue with any guest. No task blocks the investigation.

Private background can be shared or withheld. Later hearings tell you exactly what must be said. No crime confession is printed in these four play pages.

Hearing 1 / Motive

Everyone uses this same answer. When asked the shared motive question, read only the boxed words.

READ ALOUD / YOUR ANSWER

Grant threatened to withhold my final payment unless I changed the display. I had approved a temporary rig I should not have approved. My reputation was balancing on it.

Your next action

When the turn reaches the next occupied seat, ask that guest the motive question from Questions & Notes. After the hearing, write one motive you heard. You do not need to invent dialogue.

Hearing 2 / Whereabouts

Check your kept animal slip. Read ONE boxed answer. Do not read the selection labels aloud.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Read this answer

I was at the Grand Gallery lighting console from 6:40 to 6:49, dealing with adjustments to an unapproved temporary lighting rig. The museum attendant there watched me throughout. I did not go back to the Donor Salon.

ANIMAL CALLED / Read this answer

From 6:40 to 6:49, I was at the Grand Gallery lighting console. I was dealing with adjustments to an unapproved temporary lighting rig. I did not return to the Donor Salon during that time.

Listen for the fictional 6:40–6:49 window. The real locations of guests during the party are not evidence. Use only printed story facts.

Hearing 3 / Evidence

Open your EVIDENCE envelope. Choose privately: animal NOT called = Card B; animal CALLED = Card A. Submit only that letter. Keep the unused card hidden. Do not choose according to what looks safer.

On your turn, read your submitted card first. Then read ONE boxed answer below. The facilitator will count every guest's card before starting.

ANIMAL NOT CALLED / Your evidence reply

The signed record confirms the attendant watched me at the Grand Gallery lighting console throughout the whole window. It also exposes adjustments to an unapproved temporary lighting rig. I would rather be embarrassed than accused of murder.

ANIMAL CALLED / Your evidence reply

I stand by my account of being at the Grand Gallery lighting console. I dispute the service attendant's identification. I cannot produce a continuous alibi record. Please compare the time on that note with the poison window before deciding.

Put the read card on the Evidence Table. Keep your FINALE envelope sealed. Discuss, then vote privately.